# Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 914. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

## Untitled continuation (E0072)

*Continues an entry from an earlier page.*

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in the pursuit of an invisible foe, who forms his efforts, and fairly reposes in the heart of the burning solitude. The arms and defarts of the Bedoweeens are not only the disparard of their own freedom, but the barriers alio of the Happy Arabia, whole hublishing, remains from way, we canvated by the leaves of the lid and climate. The regions of Angulfus meled away in disc ease and lailitude; and it is only by a natural power that the reflection of Yemen has been facedtically attempt. ed. When Mahomer excited his holy fhandard, that Kingdom was a province of the Perian empire , yet few princes of the Thomas still regned in the mountains and the viegeregent of Chofroes was tempt ed to forget his distant country and his unfortunate matter. The influence of the age of Julianian pyr-ion the flux of the independant Arabia, who were divided by interlt or affection in the long quarral of the Eafs, the tribe of Caffan was allowed to exem on the Syrian territory: the princes of Fira were per mitted to form a city about forty miles to the south ward of the ruins if theybaby. Their favorite in the field was Ipeels and vigorous but their friendship was venal, their faith incoulant, their enemy capricions - it was an offer talk to excite them to dither these roving babarian's i and, in the familiar intercourse of war, they learned to fee, and to defiple, the fifandf weakeland both of Rome and of Parties. From Meec to the Euphrates, the Arabian tribes were confounded by the Greeks and Latinas, under the general ap- pellation of Saracens; a name which every Christian mouth has been taught to pronounce with termur and abonance.

The flavors of domestic tyranny may vastly exist in their national independence; but the Arab is formally free; and he enjoys, in some degree, the benefits of society, without forfeiting the prerogatives of nature. In every tribe, superflition, or gratitude, or fortune, has exalted a particular family above the heads of their equals. The dignities of sheich and emir invariably descend in this chosen race; but the order of succession is loose and precarious; and the most worthy or aged of the noble kinfmen are preferred to the simple, though important, office of complying disputes by their advice, and guiding valour by their example. The momentary junction of several tribes produces an army; their more lasting union constitutes a nation; and the supreme chief, the emir of emirs, whose banner is displayed at their head, may deserve, in the eyes of strangers, the honours of the kingly name. If the Arabian princes abuse their power, they are quickly punished by the defection of their subjects, who had been accustomed to a mild and parental jurisdiction. Their spirit is free, their steps are unconfined, the desert is open, and the tribes and families are held together by a mutual and voluntary compact. The foster natives of Yemen supported the pomp and majesty of a monarch; but if he could not leave his palace without endangering his life, the active powers of government must have been devolved on his nobles and magistrates. The cities of Mecca and Medina present, in the heart of Asia, the form or rather the semblance of a commonwealth. The grandfather of Mahomet, and his lineal ancestors, appear in foreign and domestic transactions as the princes of their country; but they reigned like Pericles at Athens, or the Medici at Florence, by the opinion of

their wisdom and integrity; their influence was divided with their patrimony; and the sceptre was transferred from the uncles of the prophet to a younger branch of the tribe of Koreish. On solemn occasions they convened the assembly of the people; and, since mankind must be either compelled or persuaded to obey, the use and reputation of oratory among the ancient Arabs is the clearest evidence of public freedom. But their simple freedom was of a very different cast from the nice and artificial machinery of the Greek and Roman republics, in which each member possessed an undivided share of the civil and political rights of the community. In the more simple state of the Arabs, the nation is free, because each of her sons disdains a base submission to the will of a master. His breast is fortified with the austere virtues of courage, patience, and forbearance: the love of independence prompts him to exercise the habits of self-command; and the fear of dishonour guards him from the meaner apprehension of pain, of danger, and of death. The gravity and firmness of the mind is conspicuous in its outward demeanor: his speech is slow, weighty, and concise; he is seldom provoked to laughter; his only gesture is that of stroking his beard, the venerable symbol of manhood; and the sense of his own importance teaches him to accost his equals without levity, and his superiors without awe. The liberty of the Saracens survived their conquests: the first khalifs indulged the bold and familiar language of their subjects; they affected the pulpit to persuade and edify the congregation; nor was it before the seat of empire was removed to the Tigris, that the Abbasides adopted the proud and pompous ceremonial of the Persian and Byzantine courts.

In the study of nations and men, we may observe the causes that render them hostile or friendly to each other, that tend to narrow or enlarge, to mollify or exasperate, the social character. The separation of the Arabs from the rest of mankind has accustomed them to confound the ideas of stranger and enemy; and the poverty of the land has introduced a maxim of jurisprudence, which they believe and practise to the present hour. They pretend, that in the division of the earth the rich and fertile climates were assigned to the other branches of the human family; and that the poverty of the outlaw Ishmael might recover, by fraud or force, the portion of inheritance of which he had been unjustly deprived. According to the remark of Pliny, the Arabian tribes are equally addicted to theft and merchandise: the caravans that traverse the desert are ransomed or pillaged; and their neighbours, since the remote times of Job and Sefotris, have been the victims of their rapacious spirit. If a Bedoween discovers from afar a solitary traveller, he rides furiously against him, crying, with a loud voice, "Undre's thyself, thy aunt (my wife) is without a garment." A ready submission intitles him to mercy; resistance will provoke the aggressor, and his own blood must expiate the blood which he pretends to shed in legitimate defence. A single robber, or a few associates, are branded with their genuine name; but the exploits of a numerous band assume the character of lawful and honourable war. The temper of a people, thus armed against mankind, was doubly inflamed by the domestic licence of rapine, murder, and revenge. In the constitution of Europe, the right of peace and war is

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